



WINDOWS PHONE Vs iOS Vs ANDROID



The battle of the mobile OSes still rages on, however we predict a winner already

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There was a time when Nokia ruled the smartphone world with its Symbian operating system. But today the platform is nowhere to be seen and it has been replaced by far more superior mobile ecosystems. With improvements and advancements in the hardware world, we have seen massive strides when it comes to mobile operating systems.

Apple really shook up the smartphone world with the iPhone but in recent years, Android has raised the bar and is now the most used mobile platform in the world. For that matter, even Microsoft's Windows Phone has pulled up its game and has started giving Google and Apple some stiff competition to deal with. But we come down to the ultimate question, which one is the best?

In our opinion, numbers and statistics could suggest an early winner, but frankly, it's a subjective choice, depending on how you use your smartphone to how much tinkering you like to do.

App support

Although iOS has a huge number of apps, it has fewer free apps as compared to Android. What's good about Apple purchases is that after you buy it you can install it on any Apple device you log into. Because Apple is pretty strict, there is a consistency to the quality of apps on the App store. It's also the store that gets a new app or game first (as it is the highest priority for most app developers).

Android has the largest amount of apps available in the market today and also has the largest number of free apps. In terms of quality, the apps offer an excellent user experience, almost at par with iOS. The only drawback is



The battle for your pocket, with billions upon billions of Dollars at stake

inconsistency in terms of performance (and at times, even availability), as there is a huge variety of Android devices with different versions of the operating system and different hardware.

The Windows Phone platform had a slow start in the apps department, although in recent months, we have seen some improvement. The quality of apps has been inconsistent, but with the gaining popularity of Nokia's Lumia handsets, developers have produced some good looking apps with decent user experiences. WP is still way behind the leading two though. And of the two, iOS edges ahead thanks to Apple's strict performance rules.

Score: iOS 1 - Android 0 - WP 0

Availability / Accessibility

iOS devices don't come cheap. This rules them out for the average Indian on a budget. When you consider that the cheapest current generation iOS device

available today is the iPad mini for about ₹22,000, you understand what we mean.

Android is the only one of the three that's available in all price brackets, starting from the budget ₹3,000 devices all the way up to premium gizmos closer to ₹50,000.

Windows Phone is almost exclusively Nokia, which means the range of Lumia handsets. The cheapest WP device you can buy today is the Lumia 520 for ₹8000.

Score: iOS 1 - Android 1 - WP 0

Updates

Apple is very thorough when it comes to updates. A new update is seeded to all the supported devices at the same time, globally. The only drawback is that every new update almost necessarily excludes the oldest devices. Devices which are more than two years old usually cease to get official updates.